Health & Vaccines

> **Priority B** Common stems: new vaccine, disease-free declaration, outbreak place, and new health institutes.

What to note every time

Ask yourself	Why
What is new?	Vaccine, institute, declaration
Who announced it?	WHO, ICMR, Budget, state
Where?	Country, state, city
Any number?	Outlay, number of seats, number of centres

High-Yield Health & Vaccine Foundation Anchors (Late 2025)

WHO Global Tuberculosis (TB) Report 2025 | Released 12 Nov 2025

What happened The World Health Organization (WHO) released the **Global Tuberculosis Report 2025**, assessing TB surveillance across 184 countries (representing >99% of global population).

Core facts & Global Burden - Global incident cases: **10.7 million people** in 2024 (rate: **131 new cases per 100,000 population**). - TB-HIV co-infection: **5.8%** of new TB patients globally were living with HIV. - Age/sex profile: Adult men (≥ 15 yrs) accounted for **54%** (5.8 million), adult women **35%** (3.7 million), and children ($0–14$ yrs) **11%** (1.2 million). - Regional share: **South-East Asia (34%)** > Western Pacific (27%) > African Region (25%) > Eastern Mediterranean (8.6%) > Americas (3.3%) > Europe (1.9%). - **Top 8 Countries (~two-thirds of global TB burden):** 1. **India (25%)** — single largest contributor 2. Indonesia (10%) 3. Philippines (6.8%) 4. China (6.5%) 5. Pakistan (6.3%) 6. Nigeria (4.8%) 7. DR Congo (3.9%) 8. Bangladesh (3.6%)

India's National Performance - **Incidence Decline:** India's TB incidence dropped **21%** — from **237 per lakh population in 2015 to 187 per lakh in 2024** (nearly double the global rate of decline of 12%). - **Mortality Reduction:** TB deaths among HIV-negative individuals fell from 28 per lakh (2015) to **21 per lakh (2024)**. - **Treatment Coverage:** Reached **>92% in 2024** (up from 53% in 2015). - **Notification & Missing Cases:** 26.18 lakh TB patients diagnosed in 2024 out of ~27 lakh estimated incident cases; "missing cases" slashed from **15 lakh in 2015 to under 1 lakh in 2024**.

Nafithromycin (Miqnaf) — India's First Indigenous Antibiotic | 18 Oct 2025

What happened Union Minister **Dr. Jitendra Singh** announced India's first indigenously discovered, developed, and approved novel macrolide antibiotic, **Nafithromycin**, to combat Antimicrobial Resistance (AMR).

Core facts - **Developer:** Discovered and developed with the support of **BIRAC** (Biotechnology Industry Research Assistance Council). - **Commercialization:** Marketed by **Wockhardt** under the brand name **Miqnaf**. - **Therapeutic Role:** Highly effective against drug-resistant respiratory tract infections; vital clinical intervention for cancer patients and patients with uncontrolled diabetes.

Country's First Animal Stem Cell Biobank | NIAB Hyderabad | 9 August 2025

- Union Minister **Dr. Jitendra Singh** inaugurated India's first state-of-the-art **Animal Stem Cell Biobank and Laboratory** at the **National Institute of Animal Biotechnology (NIAB)** under BRIC in **Hyderabad**.
- Objective: Advancing regenerative veterinary medicine, stem cell therapy, and cellular diagnostics for livestock breeds.

Kenya Eliminates Sleeping Sickness (HAT) | WHO Validation | 8 August 2025

- **WHO** formally validated **Kenya** for the elimination of **Human African Trypanosomiasis (HAT)**, commonly known as **Sleeping Sickness**, as a public health problem.
- **Disease Agent & Vector:** Parasitic protozoan ***Trypanosoma brucei rhodesiense*** transmitted by the bite of the **tsetse fly**.
- **Milestone:** Kenya became the **tenth country in the world** to achieve WHO validation for HAT elimination.

January 2026

India's First State-Funded BSL-4 Laboratory | Gandhinagar | 13 January 2026

What happened Union Home Minister **Amit Shah** laid the foundation stone for India's first state-funded **Bio-Safety Level-4 (BSL-4)** Bio-Containment Laboratory at the **Gujarat Biotechnology Research Centre (GBRC)** in **Gandhinagar**.

Core facts - **Biosafety Level 4:** Represents the highest level of biological containment, engineered for handling high-consequence, lethal, airborne, and often incurable pathogens (e.g., Ebola, Nipah, Marburg, Crimean-Congo hemorrhagic fever). - **Current Footprint:** India currently operates only **one civilian BSL-4 laboratory**, located at the **National Institute of Virology (NIV)** in **Pune, Maharashtra**. The GBRC Gandhinagar facility significantly expands western India's biosecurity and viral pandemic preparedness.

February 2026

Health ideas from Union Budget 2026–27

Biopharma SHAKTI

- Aim: make India strong in biologics and biosimilars.
- Money: **₹10,000 crore** over five years.
- **3 new NIPER** institutes and upgrade of **7** existing ones.
- More than **1,000** clinical trial sites.
- Stronger **CDSCO**.
- Full scheme card → Schemes.

Allied health and care workers

- Existing Allied Health Professional institutes will be upgraded, and new ones will be set up.
- About **10** selected disciplines are covered, including optometry, radiology, anaesthesia technology, OT technology, and applied psychology.
- Target noted: add about **1,00,000** Allied Health Professionals over five years.
- About **1.5 lakh** caregivers are to be trained in the coming year.

Medical tourism hubs

- A scheme will help states set up **five Regional Medical Hubs** with private partnership.
- These hubs will combine treatment, education, research, AYUSH, and post-care facilities.

Mental health

- A second **NIMHANS** (**NIMHANS-2**) is proposed in **North India**.
- National mental health institutes at **Ranchi** and **Tezpur** are to be upgraded.

AYUSH

- **3 new All India Institutes of Ayurveda**.
- Upgrade of AYUSH pharmacies and drug testing labs.
- Upgrade of the **WHO Global Traditional Medicine Centre** at **Jamnagar**.

Hospital capacity

- Budget and UP explainers spoke of expanding district hospital capacity, including emergency and trauma care. One common figure used in explainers is about a **50%** capacity push.

Nationwide HPV Vaccination Campaign for 14-Year-Old Girls | 28 February 2026

What happened India launched its nationwide free **Human Papillomavirus (HPV) vaccination campaign** on **28 February 2026** from **Ajmer, Rajasthan**, covering all 36 States and Union Territories.

Core facts - **Target Demographic: 14-year-old girls** (annual eligible cohort estimated at **1.2 crore** girls as per RGI 2021). - **Health Imperative:** Cervical cancer is the **second most common cancer among Indian women** (IARC-GLOBOCAN 2022 recorded 1,27,526 cases and 79,906 deaths in India). - **Dosage & Administration: Single-dose (0.5 ml)** Intramuscular (IM) injection in the left upper arm; administered free of cost with parental/guardian consent. - **Rollout Phases:** Initial **3-month (90-**

day) campaign mode, followed by integration into routine weekly immunization days. - **Digital Infrastructure:** Managed through the **U-WIN** portal for pre-registration, appointments, and digital certificates, while **eVIN** manages real-time vaccine stocks and cold chain logistics.

India Approves Takeda's TAK-003 (Qdenga) Dengue Vaccine

What happened CDSCO's Subject Expert Committee (SEC) under the Drugs Controller General of India (DCGI) recommended approval for **TAK-003 (Qdenga)**, making it **India's first approved dengue vaccine**.

Core facts - **Developer:** Developed by **Takeda Pharmaceuticals (Japan)**. - **Approved Age Bracket:** Individuals aged **4 to 60 years**. - **Vaccine Mechanism: Live-attenuated tetravalent vaccine** protecting against all four dengue virus serotypes (DENV 1, 2, 3, and 4). - **Genomic Backbone:** Engineered using the **DENV-2 strain** as the genetic backbone. - **Dosing Schedule: 2-dose series administered 3 months apart**.

SAHI & BODH Health AI Frameworks | 17 February 2026

What happened At the India AI Impact Summit 2026, the Union Health Ministry and MeitY unveiled two foundational health AI governance architectures:

Core facts - **SAHI (Strategy for Artificial Intelligence in Healthcare for India):** National guidance framework establishing institutional protocols for clinical validation, ethical AI deployment, algorithmic transparency, and patient data governance. - **BODH (Benchmarking Open Data Platform for Health AI):** Developed by **IIT Kanpur** in collaboration with the **National Health Authority (NHA)**. It acts as a privacy-preserving benchmarking engine allowing clinical researchers to evaluate AI models against anonymized real-world health datasets without exposing raw patient data.

2nd WHO Global Traditional Medicine Summit | Bharat Mandapam, New Delhi | 17–19 December 2025

What happened The World Health Organization (WHO) and the Ministry of Ayush, Government of India, jointly organized the **2nd WHO Global Traditional Medicine Summit** at **Bharat Mandapam, New Delhi** from **17 to 19 December 2025**.

Core facts - **Theme:** *"Restoring balance: The science and practice of health and well-being"*. - **Strategic Direction:** Advanced the implementation of the *WHO Global Traditional Medicine Strategy 2025–2034*. - **Key Launches by PM Narendra Modi:** - **Traditional Medicine Global Library:** Digital repository indexing 1.6+ million global resources. - **Health & Heritage Innovations (H2I):** Innovation pipeline bridging traditional systems with frontier technologies like AI and biotechnology. - **My Ayush Integrated Services Portal (MAISP):** Unified digital portal for Ayush services and practitioner registration. - **Ayush Mark:** Global quality certification benchmarking standard for herbal and Ayush formulations.

AYUSH Visa Category (AY) | Ministry of Home Affairs | Notified July 2023

What happened The Ministry of Home Affairs (MHA) incorporated Chapter 11A into the *Visa Manual, 2019*, creating a dedicated **AYUSH Visa** category on **27 July 2023** to boost Medical Value Travel (MVT) under the *"Heal in India"* initiative.

Core facts - **Beneficiaries:** Foreign nationals seeking therapeutic care, wellness treatments, and medical management under Indian systems of medicine (Ayurveda, Yoga, Unani, Siddha, and Homoeopathy). - **Sub-categories:** - **AY-1:** Primary Ayush patient visa. - **AY-2:** Ayush patient attendant visa. - **e-Ayush Visa & e-Ayush Attendant Visa:** Digital 60-day single/double entry facility. - **Validity:** Initial grant up to 1 year (triple entry), extendable by FRRO up to 5 years based on certified medical necessity.

Pradhan Mantri TB Mukt Bharat Abhiyaan | Launched 9 September 2022

What happened President **Droupadi Murmu** launched the **Pradhan Mantri TB Mukt Bharat Abhiyaan** to accelerate India's progress toward ending Tuberculosis by **2025** (5 years ahead of the global SDG 3.3 target of 2030).

Core facts - **Ni-kshay Mitra Initiative:** Community support mechanism where individuals, cooperative societies, elected representatives, NGOs, and corporate entities "adopt" TB patients to provide: 1. Nutritional support (food baskets of cereals, millets, pulses, and oil). 2. Additional diagnostic support. 3. Vocational training for rehabilitated patients. - **Direct Benefit Transfer:** Complemented by the **Ni-kshay Poshan Yojana** (DBT assistance for nutritional intake throughout the treatment course).

First Ayushman Arogya Mandir (Health & Wellness Centre) | 14 April 2018

What happened Prime Minister **Narendra Modi** inaugurated India's **very first Health and Wellness Centre (now rechristened 'Ayushman Arogya Mandir')** on **14 April 2018 (Ambedkar Jayanti)** at **Jangla (Jaangla), Bijapur District, Chhattisgarh**.

Core facts - **Pillars of Ayushman Bharat:** Primary tier comprises **1,50,000+ Ayushman Arogya Mandirs (HWCs)** providing Comprehensive Primary Health Care (CPHC) free of cost near homes; secondary/tertiary tier is **PM-JAY** (₹5 lakh annual health

cover per family). - **Motto / Tagline:** *"Arogyam Paramam Dhanam"* (Health is the Supreme Wealth).

India's Digital Health Architecture: NHS (2018) & NDHB (2019)

What happened India developed a layered public digital infrastructure to unify health data systems: - **National Health Stack (NHS) — July 2018:** Released by **NITI Aayog** as the foundational blueprint for a digital health ecosystem (Registries, Electronic Health Records, Coverage and Claims engines). - **National Digital Health Blueprint (NDHB) — 2019:** Released by the **Ministry of Health and Family Welfare (MoHFW)** (chaired by J. Satyanarayana). Translated the NHS into operational architecture, leading directly to the launch of the **Ayushman Bharat Digital Mission (ABDM)** with ABHA (Ayushman Bharat Health Account) IDs.

National Telemedicine & Mental Health Digital Platforms

- **e-Sanjeevani:** National Telemedicine Service of the Ministry of Health and Family Welfare. Operates in two models:
- *eSanjeevani AB-HWC:* Provider-to-Provider tele-consultation bridging Ayushman Arogya Mandirs with medical specialists in district/medical colleges.
- *eSanjeevaniOPD:* Patient-to-Doctor direct tele-consultation on mobile.
- **Tele-MANAS (Tele Mental Health Assistance and Networking Across States):** Launched on World Mental Health Day (October 2022) with toll-free 24x7 helpline number **14416**, offering free, confidential mental health counselling in multiple Indian languages.

March 2026

World TB Day | 24 March

- Date fact: **24 March** every year.
- Keep the year's official theme only after locking a WHO or MoHFW note.

Soft health–law hybrid

Supreme Court coverage on withdrawing life support in a long vegetative-state case links to dignity under **Article 21**. Details sit under National Events.

April 2026

World Health Day | 7 April 2026

What happened 7 April is World Health Day. It marks the founding anniversary of the **World Health Organization (WHO)** in **1948**.

2026 theme

- **Together for health. Stand with science.**
- The campaign stresses science-led action and the **One Health** idea (people, animals, plants, and the planet together).

Other April health days

- **World Autism Awareness Day (2 April):** Autism and Humanity — Every Life Has Value.
- **World Malaria Day (25 April):** Driven to End Malaria: Now We Can. Now We Must.
- **World Liver Day (19 April):** Solid Habits, Strong Liver (compilation theme).

10th National Summit on Innovation and Inclusivity | Chandigarh | 30 April – 1 May 2026

What happened The Union Ministry of Health and Family Welfare (MoHFW) organised the **10th National Summit on Innovation and Inclusivity: Best Practices Shaping India's Health Future** in **Chandigarh**, inaugurated by Union Health Minister **J.P. Nadda**.

Core facts & National Health Milestones - **Key Indicators Highlighted:** - Institutional deliveries rose from 79% to **89%**. - India achieved a **79% decline in under-five mortality (U5MR)** and a **73% decline in infant mortality (IMR)** over long-term health missions. - **Digital Health Portals Launched:** 1. **Swasth Bharat Portal:** A unified, one-stop national digital interface integrating multiple vertical disease control and maternal-child health programmes onto a single dashboard. 2. **JANANI Portal (Journey of Antenatal, Natal and Neonatal Integrated Care — Sehat ke Sath, Every Step of Care):** A robust digital platform aligned with

the **Ayushman Bharat Digital Mission (ABDM)** framework, designed as the single source of truth for **RMNCH** (Reproductive, Maternal, Newborn, Child, and Adolescent Health) data across all public and private facilities. 3. **Integrated Training Module for Primary Health Care Worker Teams:** Standardized, competency-based continuous medical education curriculum for frontline ASHA and ANM workers.

May 2026

Mission SEHAT | New Delhi | 11 May 2026

What happened Union Health Minister **J.P. Nadda** and Union Agriculture Minister **Shivraj Singh Chouhan** jointly launched **Mission SEHAT** in New Delhi, establishing a convergence model between agriculture, bio-fortification, and public nutrition.

Core facts - **Full Form: Science Excellence for Health through Agricultural Transformation**. - **Joint Custodians:** Conceived and executed jointly by the **Indian Council of Agricultural Research (ICAR)** and the **Indian Council of Medical Research (ICMR)**. - **Core Vision:** *"Healthy Food, Healthy Farms and a Healthy India"*. - **Mechanism:** Directs agricultural research toward breeding climate-resilient, micronutrient-dense crops (bio-fortified iron, zinc, protein) to treat community micronutrient deficiencies, stunting, and wasting.

WHO declares Ebola a Public Health Emergency of International Concern

What happened WHO declared an **Ebola** outbreak linked with the **Democratic Republic of Congo (DRC)** and **Uganda** a global health emergency in May coverage.

Core facts

- Disease: **Ebola** (severe viral haemorrhagic fever).
- Declaring body: **WHO**.
- Director-General: **Tedros Adhanom Ghebreyesus**.
- WHO HQ: **Geneva**.

May health days

- **World Thalassaemia Day: 8 May**.
- **International Nurses Day: 12 May** (Florence Nightingale's birthday; some calendars also note 13 May in compilations — fact **12 May** from WHO).
- **World No Tobacco Day: 31 May**.

> **Easy memory**

Keep Nurses Day as **12 May** for standard key facting unless a stem quotes another date.

National Family Health Survey-6 (NFHS-6) | Released 29 May 2026

What happened The Ministry of Health and Family Welfare (**MoHFW**) released the national factsheets for **NFHS-6 (2023–24)** on **29 May 2026**, conducted by the **International Institute for Population Sciences (IIPS), Mumbai** across 6.79 lakh households in 715 districts (**excluding Manipur** due to law and order).

Key Health, Fertility & Nutrition Metrics - **Total Fertility Rate (TFR)**: **2.0** (Urban: 1.6, Rural: 2.1; replacement level: 2.1). - **Institutional Deliveries**: **90.6%** (Rural: 89.2%, Urban: 94.8%). - **Skilled Birth Attendance**: **91.3%**. - **Child Immunization (12–23 months)**: Full immunization coverage rose to **87.1%**. - **Rotavirus Vaccine Coverage**: **85.4%**. - **Child Malnutrition (<5 years)**: - **Stunting (chronic)**: **29.3%** (significant drop from 35.5% in NFHS-5). - **Wasting (acute)**: **18.7%**; **Severe Wasting**: **5.2%**. - **Underweight**: **31.8%** (down from 32.1%). - **Women's Health & Autonomy**: - **Independent Bank Account**: **89.0%** (up from 78.6%). - **Internet Use**: **64.3%**. - **Mobile Phone Ownership**: **63.6%**. - **Spousal Violence**: Experienced by **22.3%** of ever-married women (declined from 29.3%). - **Demographics & Coverage**: - **Health Insurance**: **60.2%** of households covered by health insurance/financing scheme (up from 41.4%). - **Elderly Population ($\ge$60 years)**: **12.9%**. - **Overweight or Obese Adults (BMI $\ge$ 25)**: Women **30.7%**, Men **26.8%**.

Sample Registration System (SRS) Bulletin 2024 | Released 20 May 2026

What happened The **Office of the Registrar General of India (ORGI)**, Ministry of Home Affairs, released the **SRS Bulletin 2024** (Vol 59, No. 1) on **20 May 2026**.

Key Vital Demographic Metrics - **Crude Birth Rate (CBR)**: **18.3 per 1,000 population** (Rural: 20.2, Urban: 14.7). - Highest: **Bihar (26.8)**, UP (24.7), MP (23.9). - Lowest: **Andaman & Nicobar (9.9)**; States: Goa (11.6), Kerala (12.3). - **Crude Death Rate (CDR)**: **6.4 per 1,000 population** (Rural: 6.8, Urban: 5.6; Male: 7.1, Female: 5.6). - Highest: **Chhattisgarh (8.4)**, Odisha (7.9), Kerala (7.6). - Lowest: **Chandigarh (3.9)**; States: Nagaland (4.2), Delhi (4.6). - **Natural Growth Rate (NGR)**: **11.9 per 1,000 population** (Highest: **Bihar 20.8**; Lowest: **Kerala 3.9**). - **Infant Mortality Rate (IMR)**: **24 infant deaths per 1,000 live births** (Rural: 27, Urban: 17; Male: 24, Female: 25). - **1 in every 42 infants in India dies within the first year of life**. - Highest: **Chhattisgarh (36)**, MP (35), UP (34). - Lowest: **Manipur (2)**, Goa (5), Kerala (6).

June 2026

International Day of Yoga | 21 June 2026

What happened 21 June is the International Day of Yoga.

2026 theme

- **Yoga for Healthy Ageing.**

Soft health–environment link

World Environment Day and Surha Tal's Ramsar tag sit under Environment. Keep June focused on Yoga theme for health stems.

AdFalciVax: Indigenous Multi-Stage Malaria Vaccine | June 2026

What happened On **17 June 2026**, ICMR confirmed that technology for **AdFalciVax**, a novel recombinant multi-stage malaria vaccine candidate, has been licensed to five Indian pharmaceutical companies to begin clinical trials and scaled manufacturing.

Core facts - **Developer:** Developed by the **Regional Medical Research Centre (RMRC), Bhubaneswar**, under the **Indian Council of Medical Research (ICMR)**. - **Pathogen Target:** Recombinant multi-stage formulation against ***Plasmodium falciparum*** to block both individual infection and community transmission. - **Revolutionary Thermal Stability:** Stable for **up to 9 months at ambient room temperature**, completely bypassing the ultra-cold or cold-chain storage hurdles that hinder African and remote Indian immunization campaigns. - **Ultra-Affordable Economics:** Estimated production cost of just **₹20 per dose**, compared to existing global WHO-prequalified vaccines (**RTS,S/AS01 Mosquirix** and **R21/Matrix-M**) costing between **₹250 and ₹830 per dose**. - **National Goal:** Accelerates India's timeline to achieve zero indigenous malaria cases by **2027** and nationwide malaria elimination by **2030**.

July 2026

World Zoonoses Day | 6 July 2026

What happened 6 July is World Zoonoses Day.

2026 theme

- **One World, One Health: Prevent Zoonoses.**

Soft skills / youth health-adjacent days

- **World Youth Skills Day (15 July):** Skills for a Shared Future.
- Keep One Health language linked with April's World Health Day theme if a stem mixes them.

August 2026

Soft I-Day health note

Independence Day speeches also spoke about wider free hospital cover under **Ayushman Bharat** for older citizens. Before a mock, fact the exact age cut-off and rupee cover from an official note.

Soft youth day

International Youth Day falls on **12 August**. The 2026 theme was **Different Contexts, Common Aspirations**.

Third Tobacco-Free Youth Campaign (Tobacco Free Youth Campaign 3.0)

- **Launch Date & Venue**: Launched on **9 October 2025** at a hybrid event in New Delhi.
- **Inaugurated by**: Smt. **Anupriya Patel**, Union Minister of State for Health and Family Welfare.
- **Duration**: **60-day nationwide public health campaign**.
- **Six Enhanced Strategies**: 1. Intensifying public awareness campaigns regarding health hazards of tobacco and nicotine. 2. Promoting tobacco-free educational institutions (ToFEI). 3. Strengthening enforcement of COTPA, 2003 (Cigarettes and Other Tobacco Products Act). 4. Promoting tobacco-free villages (*Tambaku Mukt Gaon*). 5. Enhancing digital and social media outreach targeting adolescents and youth. 6. Expanding cessation services through the National Tobacco Quitline (NTQL) and mCessation initiatives.

September 2026

National Formulary of India (NFI) 2026 | 7th edition

What happened MoS Health **Anupriya Patel** released the **7th edition** of the **National Formulary of India (NFI 2026)** on **21 September 2026** during National Pharmacovigilance Week.

What you should remember

- Publisher / technical body: **Indian Pharmacopoeia Commission (IPC)**.
- Format: print + digital.
- Size in official coverage: about **653** monographs (including new monographs, immunologicals, and fixed-dose combinations).
- Pharmacovigilance Week: **17–23 September 2026**.
- Week theme stress: promoting **rational use of medicines** through pharmacovigilance / safer healthcare.

> **Tip**

NFI is a formulary (how medicines are used safely), not the same as the Indian Pharmacopoeia standards book — do not swap the two names in options.

October 2026

Nobel Prize in Physiology or Medicine 2026 | microRNA Discovery

What happened The Nobel Assembly at Karolinska Institutet awarded the **2026 Nobel Prize in Physiology or Medicine** jointly to American geneticists **Victor Ambros** and **Gary Ruvkun**.

Official Citation & Biological Breakthrough - **Citation:** *"For the discovery of microRNA and its role in post-transcriptional gene regulation"*. - **The Organism:** Originally discovered while studying the tiny 1-millimetre roundworm ***Caenorhabditis elegans*** (*C. elegans*). - **The Mechanism:** microRNAs are tiny, non-coding RNA molecules (typically 20 to 24 nucleotides in length) that do not code for proteins themselves. Instead, they act as cellular rheostats, binding to complementary sequences on messenger RNA (**mRNA**) molecules to either block translation into proteins or trigger mRNA degradation. - **Clinical Relevance:** Essential for embryonic development, tissue differentiation, and immune regulation. Dysregulated microRNAs are directly implicated in human oncogenesis (cancer), cardiac hypertrophy, and autoimmune diseases.

RJ Sankara Eye Hospital | Varanasi, Uttar Pradesh (20 October 2026)

What happened Prime Minister **Narendra Modi** inaugurated the **RJ Sankara Eye Hospital** at **Harhua in Varanasi**.

Core facts - **Founding Trust:** Established by the **Sri Kanchi Kamakoti Medical Trust** (associated with the Kanchi Kamakoti Peetham). - **Capacity:** A **225-bed** modern super-specialty ophthalmological hospital. - **Cross-Subsidization Model:** Operates on an equitable 70:30 healthcare model: **70% of all surgeries, consultations, and beds are provided completely free of cost** to economically underprivileged rural families, cross-subsidized by 30% paying patients. - **Catchment Area:** Caters to over 20 districts across Eastern Uttar Pradesh (Purvanchal), Western Bihar, and Jharkhand.

World Polio Day | 24 October 2026

What happened The world observed **World Polio Day** on **24 October**, marking the birth anniversary of **Dr. Jonas Salk** (who developed the first successful inactivated polio vaccine - IPV in 1955).

Core facts & India's Polio Milestones - **2026 Theme:** *"A Campaign to Reach Every Child"*. - **Global Polio Eradication Initiative (GPEI):** Led by WHO, Rotary International, CDC, UNICEF, and the Gates Foundation. - **India's Historic Polio Certification:** - **Certified Polio-Free:** India and the entire WHO South-East Asia Region were officially certified **polio-free on 27 March 2014**. - **Last Reported Case:** The last recorded wild poliovirus (WPV) case in India occurred on **13 January 2011 in Howrah, West Bengal** (a two-year-old girl, Rukhsar Khatun). - India has maintained zero indigenous transmission for over **15 years**.

World Mental Health Day | 10 October 2026

- **Theme:** *"It is time to prioritize mental health in the workplace"*.
- **National Tele-Mental Health Programme (Tele-MANAS):** India's 24x7 toll-free helpline (**14416 / 1800-891-4416**) crossed over **15 lakh distress calls handled** across 51 operational cells in 20+ languages.

Practice Zone — UPPCS Format

> **20 questions** for this sheet only — drill after you revise the months above. Formats match UPPCS 2024–25: multi-statement, Match List, NOT-matched, A/R, chronology. Full cross-topic index → Practice Zone hub.

Q1. The theme of International Day of Yoga 2026 was:

A. Yoga for Vasudhaiva Kutumbakam B. Yoga for Healthy Ageing C. Yoga for Humanity D. Yoga for Heart Health

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: Yoga Day theme only. **Ans: B.** Direct day–theme recall. Trap: older Yoga Day themes.

Q2. The 2026 theme of World Zoonoses Day locked in coverage is:

A. One World, One Health: Prevent Zoonoses B. Our Power, Our Planet C. Acting locally for global impact D. Wetlands and traditional knowledge

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: World Zoonoses Day theme. **Ans: A.** Direct theme recall. Trap: recycling Earth Day / Biodiversity themes.

Q3. Which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. World Health Day 2026 theme locked as "Together for health. Stand with science."
2. May coverage linked a WHO Ebola emergency concern with DRC and Uganda.
3. World Health Day is observed on 22 April.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. 1 and 2 only B. 2 and 3 only C. 1 and 3 only D. 1, 2 and 3

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: WHO Health Day vs Ebola emergency (May soft health). **Ans: A.** (3) false — Health Day is **7 April**; 22 April is Earth Day. Trap: day collision.

Q4. With reference to health institutes in Budget / early-2026 coverage, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. NIMHANS-2 in North India was spoken of in Budget-linked health messaging.
2. Three All India Institutes of Ayurveda and a Jamnagar WHO centre upgrade appeared in coverage.
3. Biopharma SHAKTI included a target of 1,000+ clinical trial sites in coverage.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. 1 and 2 only B. 2 and 3 only C. 1 and 3 only D. 1, 2 and 3

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: WHO / Ayush soft health from Budget. **Ans: D.** Health CA is thin post-COVID but Budget clusters still appear. Trap: putting NIMHANS-2 in Bengaluru only by habit.

Q5. With reference to Budget 2026–27 health messaging, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. NIMHANS-2 was proposed for North India.
2. Three new All India Institutes of Ayurveda were proposed.
3. The WHO Global Traditional Medicine Centre at Jamnagar is to be upgraded.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. 1 and 2 only B. 2 and 3 only C. 1 and 3 only D. 1, 2 and 3

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: NIMHANS-2 / Ayurveda institutes / Jamnagar WHO centre. **Ans: D.** Soft health cluster. Trap: putting NIMHANS-2 only in Bengaluru by habit.

Q6. With reference to Biopharma SHAKTI, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. Outlay locked at ₹10,000 crore over five years.
2. Coverage spoke of three new NIPER institutes and upgrading seven older ones.
3. Coverage spoke of 1,000+ clinical trial sites.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. 1 and 2 only B. 2 and 3 only C. 1 and 3 only D. 1, 2 and 3

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: Biopharma SHAKTI trial sites + NIPER. **Ans: D.** Health–scheme hybrid. Trap: equating with old PLI Pharma only.

Q7. Which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. World Health Day is 7 April.
2. 2026 theme: Together for health. Stand with science.
3. World Health Day is 22 April.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. 1 and 2 only B. 2 and 3 only C. 1 and 3 only D. 1, 2 and 3

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: World Health Day date 7 April. **Ans: A.** 22 April = Earth Day.

Q8. Which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. International Day of Yoga is 21 June.
2. 2026 theme: Yoga for Healthy Ageing.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. Only 2 B. Neither 1 nor 2 C. Both 1 and 2 D. Only 1

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: Yoga Day health sheet. **Ans: C.** Both true.

Q9. Which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. World Zoonoses Day theme: One World, One Health: Prevent Zoonoses.

2. Date locked 6 July in day board.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. Only 2 B. Neither 1 nor 2 C. Both 1 and 2 D. Only 1

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: Zoonoses Day One Health. **Ans: C.** Both true.

Q10. Which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. May coverage linked WHO Ebola emergency concern with DRC and Uganda.
2. It redesignated Surha Tal as a WHO site.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. Only 2 B. Neither 1 nor 2 C. Both 1 and 2 D. Only 1

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: Ebola WHO emergency DRC Uganda. **Ans: D.** (2) false.

Q11. Which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. Budget scheme helps states set up five Regional Medical Hubs with private partnership.
2. Hubs combine treatment, education, research, AYUSH, post-care.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. Only 2 B. Neither 1 nor 2 C. Both 1 and 2 D. Only 1

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: Medical tourism five regional hubs. **Ans: C.** Both true.

Q12. Which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. Target add about 1,00,000 Allied Health Professionals over five years.
2. About 1.5 lakh caregivers to be trained in the coming year.
3. Target is 1 crore doctors in one year.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. 1 and 2 only B. 2 and 3 only C. 1 and 3 only D. 1, 2 and 3

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: Allied health 1 lakh professionals. **Ans: A.** (3) invented.

Q13. Which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. International Youth Day 12 August theme: Different Contexts, Common Aspirations.
2. It is observed on 15 August.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. Only 2 B. Neither 1 nor 2 C. Both 1 and 2 D. Only 1

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: Youth Day theme Aug health-adjacent. **Ans: D.** 12 Aug.

Q14. Which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. Biopharma SHAKTI messaging includes stronger CDSCO.
2. Outlay ₹10,000 crore / 5 years.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. Only 2 B. Neither 1 nor 2 C. Both 1 and 2 D. Only 1

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: CDSCO stronger under Biopharma SHAKTI. **Ans: C.** Both true.

Q15. Which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. NIMHANS-2 proposed for North India.
2. It replaces AIIMS Delhi entirely.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. Only 2 B. Neither 1 nor 2 C. Both 1 and 2 D. Only 1

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: Mental health NIMHANS-2. **Ans: D.** (2) false.

Q16. Which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. About 10 selected allied disciplines include optometry, radiology, anaesthesia technology.
2. Allied health upgrades appear in Budget health messaging.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. Only 2 B. Neither 1 nor 2 C. Both 1 and 2 D. Only 1

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: Optometry radiology allied disciplines. **Ans: C.** Both true.

Q17. Which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. Ayush Anudan Portal launched for end-to-end scheme funding (Ministry of Ayush).
2. It replaces the Union Health Ministry.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. Only 2 B. Neither 1 nor 2 C. Both 1 and 2 D. Only 1

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: Ayush Anudan Portal soft. **Ans: D.** (2) false.

Q18. Which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. WHO Global Traditional Medicine Centre at Jamnagar to be upgraded.
2. Three new AIIA proposed.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. Only 2 B. Neither 1 nor 2 C. Both 1 and 2 D. Only 1

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: WHO traditional medicine Jamnagar. **Ans: C.** Both true.

Q19. Which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. Health Day 2026 theme includes Stand with science.
2. Earth Day theme is Our Power, Our Planet.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. Only 2 B. Neither 1 nor 2 C. Both 1 and 2 D. Only 1

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: Stand with science Health Day. **Ans: C.** Both true — day collision drill.

Q20. Which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. Zoonoses Day theme includes Prevent Zoonoses.
2. Theme is identical to WED 2026 Inspired by Nature…

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. Only 2 B. Neither 1 nor 2 C. Both 1 and 2 D. Only 1

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: Prevent Zoonoses wording. **Ans: D.** (2) false.